

Gautam Velpula

Vice President, Engineering

Consumer Web, Mobile & Platform Engineering • Subscriptions & Personalization • Operational Excellence & Reliability • Global Team Leadership

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Executive Summary

Engineering leader with 18+ years building, scaling, and operating consumer-facing web, mobile, and platform products for millions of users across multi-brand retail, payments, and digital media-adjacent businesses. Proven track record leading large, global, cross-functional engineering organizations; delivering high-performance apps and services across Web, iOS, and Android; and driving operational excellence through rigorous reliability, observability, and incident management. A hands-on, player-coach leader who pairs architectural depth with people leadership — setting ambitious strategy, developing high-performing managers and engineers, and partnering closely with Product, Design, and Marketing to ship best-in-class customer experiences.

Core Competencies

Engineering Leadership at Scale • Consumer Web & Mobile (iOS / Android) • Platform & Services Architecture • Subscriptions & Personalization • Operational Excellence & Reliability (SLOs, Incident Management) • Observability, Load Testing & Performance • Cloud & Microservices • Player-Coach / Hands-On Leadership • Global Team Building & Manager Development • Cross-Functional Delivery (Product, Design, Marketing) • Executive Stakeholder Management • Continuous Delivery & DevOps

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Lead engineering and architecture strategy for a multi-brand consumer organization serving millions of customers across web and mobile, partnering directly with executive leadership to align technology strategy with business outcomes.
- Delivered a unified consumer platform consolidating 7 independent brand apps and websites across **Web, iOS, and Android**, standardizing the experience and materially reducing development and operating cost while improving performance.
- Architected and delivered a **subscription platform** to support new consumer business models, including a hands-on stop-gap service that stabilized revenue during legacy system failures.
- Re-architected backend systems to a cloud-native, microservices, event-driven architecture, standardizing APIs and integration patterns to support high-throughput, resilient, and observable services.
- Drove **operational excellence** across apps, services, and infrastructure — establishing monitoring, alerting, and incident-management practices with Splunk and analytics tooling, improving system uptime by approximately 30%.
- Governed personalization through a centralized customer data model and CDP/Martech integrations, enabling accurate analytics, attribution, and tailored customer experiences.
- Partnered cross-functionally with Product, Design, and Marketing to prioritize and deliver architecture and feature initiatives, continuously improving functionality, usability, and simplicity.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30% through architectural standardization, platform consolidation, and continuous delivery.

- Built and led a senior engineering and architecture organization of principal and lead engineers, developing managers and individual contributors and fostering a culture of strong engineering ownership.
- Remained a hands-on, player-coach leader through periods of attrition and transformation, taking on design, architecture, and delivery responsibilities directly when needed.
- Chair the enterprise AI Working Group and drive adoption of GenAI and Agentic AI capabilities with defined guardrails and governance for safe, scalable use.

Slalom Consulting

2018 – 2021

Senior Delivery Principal

- Senior engineering and delivery lead for multi-million-dollar digital, cloud modernization, and payments engagements with Fortune 500 and large-scale eCommerce clients.
- Led cross-functional engineering teams spanning architecture, product, and design across concurrent multi-year engagements, delivering high-performance consumer and platform solutions.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP for a leading point-of-sale provider, modernizing infrastructure, data, and application tiers for scale and reliability.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization, addressing resilience and high-volume, low-latency transaction processing.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models across engineering teams, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Served as primary executive-facing technology advisor, translating business strategy into actionable engineering roadmaps and delivery plans.
- Directed multiple multi-million-dollar engagements, achieving approximately 95% client satisfaction and consistent repeat business.
- Mentored delivery leaders, engineers, and architects, strengthening leadership depth and delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)

2014 – 2018

Director, Professional Services

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations and integrations for Fortune 500 clients with end-to-end accountability across solution architecture, delivery, and post-launch optimization.
- Led and grew a global organization of engineers, managers, and delivery leaders across multiple regions, influencing across teams without direct authority.
- Served as senior-most technical leader within services, providing architectural guidance, escalation support, and hands-on problem solving for critical challenges.
- Advised C-level stakeholders, aligning delivery with business outcomes and managing executive relationships with professionalism and discretion.
- Built and scaled a global professional services organization through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.

Technology & Methodology

Web & Mobile: Next.js, React Native (iOS & Android), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS

Backend & Services: Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST / GraphQL APIs, API Gateways

Cloud & Platform: AWS, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions, Blob Storage), Vercel, Cloudflare

Reliability & Observability: Splunk, GA4, Firebase, monitoring & alerting, incident management, load & performance testing

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB (MongoDB & PostgreSQL APIs), Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

Subscriptions, Payments & Personalization: FreedomPay, Amperity CDP, Olo, Punchh, Yext, Qu

POS

AI / ML: GenAI, Agentic AI, LLM application patterns, AI governance & guardrails

Methodologies: Agile / Scrum, DevOps & Continuous Delivery, Platform Engineering, Operational Excellence

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology

2007 – 2009

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science

2002 – 2006

Osmania University, Hyderabad, India